

The Nokia Hackathon Report

>>The 24-Hour coding Fiesta, for the GREATER GOOD
> by Swapnil Mathur

Nokia has had a long standing reputation for not just making great phones, but also for being a company that has prided itself in it's long standing tradition for holding social causes very close to its corporate heart. They were one of the first companies way back to implement an eco-friendly packaging design, with all their material being made of recycled paper and later switched to smaller chargers that were better for the environment. Continuing that tradition, Nokia India, in partnership with Devworx set out on a three city "Hackathon" in the hopes of achieving something good, for a greater cause.

The Goal

Nokia hosted three such Hackathons, in Delhi (29th&30th June), Bangalore (6th&7th July) and Pune (27th & 28th July), respectively. It saw a large number of creative minds come together to create apps for Windows Phone and S4O platforms. More than 600 ideas were received across cities, out of which approximately 120 top ideas were selected to for the program. The Hackathons had developers focus on any of the three areas that need immediate addressing, that is, health, education and environment.

The Process

After Nokia shortlisted ideas with potential, the participants were given some time from intimation till the date of the actual Hackathon to start developing their apps. On the day of the Hackathon, many participants arrived with semi-complete apps. At the Hackathon, a 24 hour coding extravaganza, is where these developers would finish coding their apps, fighting through sleep and fatigue. However, it didn't end there. At the end of the event, all developers/teams had



Presentations being evaluated

to present their Apps, showcasing the ideology behind them along with a small demo.

The presentations were made in front of a panel of eminent Jurors, who evaluated each of the presentations (and apps) on two grounds; technical merits and the "Do Good" factor. The technical merits involved in evaluating the apps were ease of use, innovation and the potential for scalability.

The Do Good part of the evaluation process looked at how much of a social good the app contributed to and just how severe was the issue that the app set out to tackle. While there is seldom a fair and direct comparison between the aching needs of the health, education and environment sector, it was the Jury that made sure a fair and well balanced perspective was maintained. Apps that lived up to all the above expectations were allowed to proceed.

The Jury

Each city's Hackathon was graced by a Jury comprising of eminent educators, entrepreneurs, environmentalist and NGO workers. A healthy mix of people from every walk of life allowed the Jury to choose apps without a bias towards any one particular social cause. The Jury was asked to select 10 app ideas as the best from each city, which would then move forward to the second round of evaluation, performed by a Grand Jury.

The Grand Jury

From early August, the Nokia Do Good Hackathon brought to New Delhi 11 of the most influential minds and passionate leaders who came together with one shared goal: to unlock the potential of new



Developers hard at work. Sans sleep and the comforts of home.